



Need for speed: No running event is as raw as the 100m. It is the antithesis of complication — eight racers, their legs, and a straightforward test to see who can finish the fastest. GETTY IMAGES

the eight-man final. A hundred desperate metres later, he finished just 5/1000 of a second ahead of Kishane Thompson of Jamaica.

Tickets to watch that Sunday's evening session of the athletics competition at the Stade de France cost an eye-popping €980. If you were paying that kind of money, chances are you weren't doing it

solely for the pleasure of watching the women's high jump, the men's hammer throw, or the semifinals of the men's 1500m.

Running is perhaps the most basic athletic trait of humans and the one that matters the most. Sure, there are other running events, but none as raw as the 100m. It is the antithesis of complication — eight

racers, their legs, and a straightforward test to see who can finish the fastest.

Who grew up wanting to be the world's best hammer thrower? Ethan Katzberg, probably — but not many others. Yet, who didn't dream of being the fastest runner in the world?

While most of us might have dreamt of it, only Noah Lyles gets to